

Child diabetes discovery could lead to future drug breakthrough

有关儿童糖尿病的新发现可能带来未来的药物突破

科学家发现，1 型糖尿病在低龄儿童身上发病时更严重、来势更凶猛。1 型糖尿病是免疫系统攻击控制血糖水平的胰腺细胞造成的。

Children, particularly those under the age of seven, seem to develop more **aggressive** type 1 diabetes than those **diagnosed** later in life. Researchers at the University of Exeter studied **pancreas** samples from 250 **donors**, allowing them to see how the beta cells which produce the **hormone** insulin formed normally and in type 1.

儿童，尤其是七岁以下的儿童，似乎比在年龄更大时诊断出的人 1 型糖尿病发展得更凶猛。埃克塞特大学的研究人员仔细研究了来自 250 名捐赠者的胰腺样本，这让他们得以一窥产生胰岛素这种激素的胰岛 β 细胞在正常人的胰腺和 1 型糖尿病患者的胰腺中形成方式的区别。

They showed early in life the beta cells live in small **clusters** which are easy for the **immune system** to **pick off** and destroy. The researchers say it's a really significant finding and that the future was looking much brighter with drugs that can slow the immune system's attack.

这些样本显示出在生命早期胰岛 β 细胞会以小团的形式存在，这让免疫系统能够轻易地识别并破坏它们。研究人员称这项发现意义重大，它为糖尿病治疗的未来带来了希望，因为将会有可以减缓免疫系统攻击的药物。

词汇表

aggressive	凶猛的，侵略性的
diagnosed	被诊断出
pancreas	胰腺
donor	捐赠者
hormone	激素
cluster	小团，小簇
immune system	免疫系统
pick off	识别

听力练习（答案见下页）

一、听第一遍音频，回答问题。

1. What have the researchers discovered?
 - a. How diabetes affects people
 - b. How the human body fights diabetes

二、用一分钟阅读下列问题，然后听第二遍音频并回答问题。

1. Children fight off diabetes more aggressively than adults.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given
2. The beta cells studied were taken from the _____.

3. Beta cells produce _____.
 - a. blood sugar
 - b. diabetes
 - c. insulin

4. It is easy for the immune system to destroy beta cells early in life because _____.
 - a. they are small
 - b. they exist in small groups
 - c. they are weak

三、听第三遍音频，将句子补充完整。（提示：可以反复听，直到听清楚每一个词）

1. Children, particularly those under the age of seven, seem to develop more aggressive type 1 diabetes than those diagnosed _____.

2. They showed early in life that beta cells live in small clusters which are easy for the immune system to _____.

答案

一、听第一遍音频，回答问题。

1. What have the researchers discovered?

b. Researchers have learned how the body produces beta cells to fight diabetes.

二、用一分钟阅读下列问题，然后听第二遍音频并回答问题。

1. **c. Not given.** This article does not comment how aggressively people fight off diabetes

2. The beta cells studied were taken from the **pancreas**.

3. **c. Researchers at the University of Exeter studied pancreas samples from 250 donors, allowing them to see how the *beta cells which produce the hormone insulin* formed normally and in type 1.**

4. **b. They showed early in life that beta cells live in *small clusters which are easy for the immune system to pick off and destroy*.**

三、听第三遍音频，将句子补充完整。（提示：可以反复听，直到听清楚每一个词）

1. Children, particularly those under the age of seven, seem to develop more aggressive type 1 diabetes than those diagnosed **later in life**.

2. They showed early in life that beta cells live in small clusters which are easy for the immune system to **pick off and destroy**.